

DOUBT

1. Passage anchor

> “Even now, I can still hear her voice in the back of my mind whenever I feel **self-doubt** creeping in.”

Passage meaning

doubt = a feeling of uncertainty or lack of confidence

懷疑；不確定；缺乏信心

In **self-doubt**, the uncertainty is directed toward **your own ability, judgment, or worth**.

self-doubt

= lack of confidence in yourself

自我懷疑；對自己的能力或判斷缺乏信心

Practice

1. **Self-doubt** sometimes makes capable people hesitate.

自我懷疑有時會讓有能力的人猶豫不前。

2. She learned not to let **doubt** stop her from speaking up.

她學會不讓**懷疑與不安**阻止自己發言。

Core meanings of DOUBT

2. doubt — noun: uncertainty about whether something is true or will happen

= a feeling of not being certain about something

懷疑；疑問；不確定

Examples

1. I have serious **doubts** about his explanation.

我對他的解釋有很大的**懷疑**。

2. There is some **doubt** about whether the plan will work.

這個計畫是否可行，仍有一些**疑問**。

3. have doubts about something

= feel uncertain or unconvinced about something

****對.....有疑慮；懷疑.....****

Examples

1. I'm beginning to ****have doubts about the plan****.

我開始對這個計畫****產生疑慮****。

2. She had no ****doubts about his ability****.

她對他的能力****毫不懷疑****。

4. doubt — lack of confidence

= uncertainty about your own or someone else's ability, judgment, or prospects

****不信任；缺乏信心；懷疑****

Examples

1. His comments filled me with ****doubt****.

他的話讓我充滿****懷疑與不安****。

2. She never showed any ****doubt**** about her decision.

她從未對自己的決定表現出任何****不確定****。

This is especially close to ****self-doubt****.

5. self-doubt

= lack of confidence in your own abilities or decisions

****自我懷疑；對自己缺乏信心****

Examples

1. Years of criticism created a lot of ****self-doubt****.

多年的批評讓他產生了很多****自我懷疑****。

2. She pushed through her ****self-doubt**** and applied for the role.

她克服了****自我懷疑****，申請了那個職位。

Verb meaning

6. doubt something

= believe that something may not be true, correct, or likely

****懷疑；不相信****

Examples

1. I ****doubt his story****.

我****懷疑他說的故事****。

2. She ****doubted the accuracy of the report****.

她****懷疑報告的準確性****。

7. doubt that...

= think that something is probably not true or will probably not happen

****懷疑.....；不太相信.....****

Examples

1. I ****doubt that he'll come****.

我****懷疑他會來 / 我覺得他大概不會來****。

2. She ****doubted that the plan would succeed****.

她****懷疑這個計畫能否成功****。

Important nuance

In many contexts:

****I doubt that... ****

often leans toward

****I think probably not... ****

8. doubt whether / if...

= be uncertain whether something is true or will happen

****不確定是否.....；懷疑是否.....****

Examples

1. I **doubt whether this is the best solution**.

我**不確定這是不是最好的解決方法**。

2. She **doubted if he would agree**.

她**懷疑他是否會同意**。

Doubting a person

9. doubt someone

= lack confidence in someone's honesty, ability, or judgment

懷疑某人；對某人缺乏信心

Examples

1. I never **doubted her**.

我從未**懷疑過她**。

2. His team began to **doubt him** after several poor decisions.

幾次錯誤決策後，他的團隊開始**對他失去信心**。

Context decides whether the doubt concerns:

* honesty

* competence

* reliability

* judgment

Fixed expressions

10. no doubt

= certainly; very probably; without much uncertainty

毫無疑問；無疑地

Examples

1. She will **no doubt** be pleased.

她**無疑**會很高興。

2. **No doubt**, the experience changed him.

****毫無疑問****，那次經歷改變了他。

Depending on context, it can range from strong certainty to “very probably.”

11. without doubt

= certainly; unquestionably

****毫無疑問地****

Examples

1. She is, ****without doubt****, the strongest candidate.

她****毫無疑問****是最強的候選人。

2. This was ****without doubt**** his best performance.

這****毫無疑問****是他最好的表現。

More formal than ****no doubt****.

12. beyond doubt

= completely certain

****毫無疑問；確定無疑****

Examples

1. Her honesty is ****beyond doubt****.

她的誠信****毋庸置疑****。

2. The evidence placed the fact ****beyond doubt****.

證據使這項事實****確定無疑****。

13. beyond reasonable doubt

= legal standard requiring very high certainty before criminal conviction

****排除合理懷疑；超越合理懷疑****

Examples

1. The prosecution must prove guilt ****beyond reasonable doubt****.

控方必須證明有罪達到**排除合理懷疑**的程度。

2. The jury was not convinced **beyond reasonable doubt**.
陪審團並未被說服到**排除合理懷疑**的程度。

Important legal expression.

14. cast doubt on something

= make something seem less certain or credible

使人懷疑；對.....造成疑問

Examples

1. The new evidence **casts doubt on** the original explanation.
新證據使人**懷疑**原本的解釋。
2. His inconsistent answers **cast doubt on his credibility**.
他前後不一致的回答讓人**質疑他的可信度**。

Very useful formal expression.

15. raise doubts

= cause people to become uncertain

引起疑慮；令人懷疑

Examples

1. The delay **raised doubts** about the project.
延誤**引起了人們對專案的疑慮**。
2. The results **raised serious doubts** about the method.
結果讓人對這個方法產生了**嚴重懷疑**。

16. leave room for doubt

= allow uncertainty to remain

留下懷疑空間；仍有疑問

Examples

1. His explanation **left room for doubt**.
他的解釋仍然**留下疑點**。
2. The evidence leaves little **room for doubt**.
這些證據幾乎**沒有留下懷疑的空間**。

17. give someone the benefit of the doubt

= choose to believe someone or assume the best when you are uncertain
姑且相信某人；往好處想

Examples

1. I'll **give him the benefit of the doubt**.
我會先**姑且相信他**。
2. She decided to **give her colleague the benefit of the doubt**.
她決定先**往好處想，相信同事沒有惡意**。

Highly useful idiom.

18. have no doubt that...

= be completely certain that something is true
毫不懷疑.....；確信.....

Examples

1. I **have no doubt that she will succeed**.
我**毫不懷疑她會成功**。
2. He **had no doubt that he had made the right choice**.
他**確信自己作出了正確選擇**。

19. there is no doubt that...

= it is certain that...
毫無疑問.....

Examples

1. There is **no doubt** that communication matters.
毫無疑問，溝通很重要。
2. There is **no doubt** that the experience influenced her.
毫無疑問，那次經歷影響了她。

Doubt as hesitation / uncertainty in action

20. a moment of doubt

= a brief period of uncertainty or loss of confidence

一瞬間的懷疑；短暫動搖

Examples

1. She had a brief **moment of doubt** before going on stage.
上台前，她有過短暫的**動搖**。
2. For a moment, **doubt** entered his mind.
有那麼一瞬間，他心中產生了**疑慮**。

21. doubt creeps in

= uncertainty gradually begins to appear

懷疑逐漸浮現；疑慮慢慢產生

This is the exact passage image.

Examples

1. When progress is slow, **doubt can creep in**.
當進展緩慢時，**懷疑可能會慢慢浮現**。
2. As the deadline approached, **doubt began to creep in**.
隨著截止日期逼近，**不安與懷疑開始悄悄出現**。

This is figurative:

something unwanted enters gradually and quietly.

Religious / philosophical use

22. doubt — uncertainty about belief or faith

= uncertainty about religious, philosophical, or deeply held beliefs

****懷疑；信念上的疑惑****

Examples

1. He went through a period of religious ****doubt****.

他曾經歷一段宗教信仰上的****疑惑期****。

2. The book explores faith and ****doubt****.

這本書探討信仰與****懷疑****。

Established abstract sense.

Related forms

23. doubtful

A. uncertain whether something is true

****懷疑的；不確定的****

1. I'm ****doubtful about his explanation****.

我對他的解釋****有些懷疑****。

B. unlikely

****不太可能的****

2. It is ****doubtful whether the plan will succeed****.

這個計畫能否成功****很難說 / 不太樂觀****。

24. doubtful — of uncertain quality or reliability

= questionable or not clearly trustworthy

****可疑的；不可靠的****

Examples

1. The claim is based on **doubtful evidence**.
這項主張建立在**可疑的證據**上。

2. The source is of **doubtful reliability**.
這個來源的可靠性**值得懷疑**。

25. doubtfully

= in an uncertain or unconvinced manner
懷疑地；不確定地

Examples

1. She looked at him **doubtfully**.
她**懷疑地**看著他。

2. "Are you sure?" he asked **doubtfully**.
「你確定嗎？」他**帶著懷疑地**問。

26. doubtful vs dubious

These overlap in some contexts.

doubtful
= uncertain, unlikely, or questionable
不確定的；可疑的

dubious
= doubtful or suspicious, often implying poor credibility or quality
可疑的；令人不信任的

Example:

* a **doubtful outcome** = 結果未定
* a **dubious claim** = 可疑、不太可信的說法

27. undoubted

= certain; unquestioned

****無疑的；確定的****

Examples

1. She has ****undoubted talent****.

她的才華是****毋庸置疑的****。

2. His experience is an ****undoubted advantage****.

他的經驗是****毫無疑問的優勢****。

More formal.

28. undoubtedly

= certainly; without doubt

****毫無疑問地；無疑****

Examples

1. She is ****undoubtedly talented****.

她****毫無疑問很有天分****。

2. The decision will ****undoubtedly**** have consequences.

這項決定****無疑****會帶來後果。

29. self-doubting

= lacking confidence in yourself or frequently questioning your own ability

****自我懷疑的；缺乏自信的****

Examples

1. He became increasingly ****self-doubting****.

他變得愈來愈****缺乏自信****。

2. Her earlier writing was more ****self-doubting**** in tone.

她早期的寫作語氣比較****不自信****。

Less common than the noun ****self-doubt****.

Key contrasts

30. doubt vs uncertainty

****uncertainty****

= general state of not knowing what is true or what will happen

****不確定性****

****doubt****

= active questioning or lack of belief/confidence

****懷疑；疑慮****

Compare:

> There is considerable ****uncertainty**** about the future.

> 未來有很大的****不確定性****。

> I have serious ****doubts**** about the plan.

> 我對這個計畫有嚴重的****疑慮****。

31. doubt vs suspicion

****doubt****

= uncertainty about whether something is true or reliable

****懷疑****

****suspicion****

= belief or feeling that something bad, dishonest, or wrong may be happening

****猜疑；嫌疑****

Compare:

> I ****doubt**** his explanation.

> 我不太相信他的解釋。

> I ****suspect**** he is hiding something.

> 我懷疑他在隱瞞什麼。

****Suspicion**** often points toward a specific negative possibility.

32. doubt vs question

As verbs:

****doubt****

= not believe or be uncertain about something

****懷疑****

****question****

= challenge, examine, or express doubt about something

****質疑****

Compare:

> I ****doubt his story****.

> 我不太相信他的說法。

> I ****question his judgment****.

> 我對他的判斷力提出****質疑****。

****Question**** often sounds more active and analytical.

33. doubt vs hesitate

****doubt****

= feel uncertain about truth, ability, or outcome

****懷疑；不確定****

****hesitate****

= pause before acting or speaking because of uncertainty

****猶豫****

Doubt may cause hesitation, but they are not the same.

> She ****doubted herself****, so she ****hesitated**** before answering.

> 她****懷疑自己****，所以回答前****猶豫了****。

34. doubt vs distrust

****doubt****

= be uncertain whether someone or something is reliable or true

****distrust****

= actively lack trust in someone or something

****不信任****

****Distrust**** is generally stronger and more stable.

Grammar patterns

35. doubt + noun

* doubt the story

* doubt his ability

* doubt the result

Example

I ****doubt the accuracy**** of the figures.

我****懷疑這些數字的準確性****。

36. doubt + that-clause

> I doubt ****that this will work****.

= I think it probably will not work.

****我懷疑這是否可行 / 我覺得大概行不通。****

37. doubt + whether / if

> I doubt ****whether we have enough time****.

= I am uncertain whether...

****我不確定我們是否有足夠時間。****

38. no doubt + clause

> ****No doubt**** she was nervous.

= She was almost certainly nervous.

****她無疑很緊張。****

Meaning map

The central concept of **doubt** is:

lack of certainty or confidence

From this develop several branches:

Truth

doubt a claim

→ **懷疑真假**

Outcome

doubt whether something will happen

→ **不確定結果**

Person

doubt someone

→ **對某人缺乏信任或信心**

Self-confidence

self-doubt

→ **自我懷疑**

Formal credibility

cast doubt on something

→ **使.....受到質疑**

Legal certainty

beyond reasonable doubt

→ **排除合理懷疑**

The common thread is always:

certainty is incomplete or weakened.

Passage recap

> “...whenever I feel **self-doubt** creeping in.”

Here:

self-doubt = **lack of confidence in your own abilities, judgment, or worth**

And:

creeping in suggests that the doubt enters gradually and quietly.

Best Traditional Chinese renderings:

* **自我懷疑**

* **對自己失去信心**

* **懷疑自己的能力**

* contextually: **每當自我懷疑悄悄浮上心頭時**

MCQ-ready meaning

doubt in **self-doubt**

= **uncertainty or lack of confidence**

懷疑；不確定；缺乏信心

It is not primarily about doubting an external fact here. The doubt is directed inward, toward **the speaker's own ability and confidence**.